LAYOUT REVIEW · DRAFT 2 · 16 OCT 2026

midnight-lite.com v2

Draft 2, with your markup from draft 1 applied. Pink boxes starting with **Changed:** show what moved. Mark up again, or just say "looks good" and I'll start building it in Astro.

How to review

1. Each page of this PDF is one page of the site, shown at desktop width. There's a notes column on the right for handwriting.
2. Every section has a pink tag (`H1`, `P3`...). Refer to it in comments, e.g. *"H4: no newsletter, just YouTube subscribe"*.
3. Pink boxes explain what a section is for, or ask you something. They won't be on the real site.
4. **Text in [brackets]** and grey "photo" boxes are placeholders. Layout and structure matter now; wording and pictures come later.
5. Page 3 lists your answers from draft 1 and the few things I still need from you.

What's in this draft

PDF page	Site page	Tags
4	Home	NAV, H1–H7, FOOT
5	Projects (portfolio)	P1–P3
6	Project page (case study template)	D1–D7
7	Videos (YouTube channel hub)	V1–V3
8	Build log (blog list)	B1–B4
9	First post: "Rebuilding this website"	A1–A4
10	About (skills, timeline, gear)	AB1–AB3
11	Tools (was "Services")	T1–T2
12	Contact (was Community)	C1–C3
13	Home on a phone + dark mode	

Live preview on the home network: http://192.168.1.196:8091/next/ (add `?review` to see the tags). The current live site isn't changed.

NOTES

PAGE 2 · UPDATED

Site map: old → new

Same brand and spirit, re-centred on three things: **projects** (portfolio), **videos** (YouTube) and **build logs** (blog), with questions answered in the **YouTube comments**.

Today	New	What changes
Home (hero, carousel)	**Home**	Clear pitch, "now making" strip, latest video, featured projects, latest posts, email call-out.
Projects + project1–3.html	**Projects** + one **project page** template	Filter by topic, status badges; every project gets the same case-study layout (story, timeline, files, link to the video's comments). Old URLs redirect.
(none)	**Videos**	New. Channel hub that fills itself from YouTube; series = playlists.
Dev Log (progress.html)	**Build log** + post pages	Becomes a real blog: posts written in Markdown, per project and series, plus a newsletter. Site updates become one category.
About	**About**	Portfolio-style: skills, timeline, gear.
Services (app launcher)	**Tools**	Renamed; EUC visualiser kept as-is.
Contact (footer only)	**Contact**	Contact form, video ideas, newsletter, link to YouTube comments. Fake phone/LinkedIn removed.
404 / under construction	Kept	Restyled to match.

Navigation

Home · Projects · Videos · Build log · Tools · About · Contact · ▶ YouTube

On phones these fold into a Menu button. Footer repeats the links plus YouTube, Instagram, GitHub and email.

How things connect

Video ⇄ Project page ⇄ Build log posts. Each project page lists its videos and posts; each video and post links back to its project. Questions go to the YouTube comments; project pages and posts link there.

NOTES

PAGE 3

Your answers, and what's left

From your markup of draft 1. Cross out anything I misread.

Decided

Question	Your answer	Where it shows
Comments	YouTube comments only, no discussion on the site	Community page became Contact; project and post pages link to YouTube
How it's built	Astro (posts and projects in Markdown)	Next step after this draft
Newsletter	Yes	Home H4, build log sidebar, Contact
How you appear	Handle + logo: **@midnightlite** (also the YouTube handle)	About AB1; every YouTube button links to youtube.com/@midnightlite
Public projects	Ferrofluid, EUC visualiser, This website	Listed first on Projects; This website featured on Home
Contact email	Keep enquiry@midnight-lite.com	Everywhere
Drop / add	Nothing	
First blog post	Document this website change	Page 9, written as a draft in your voice

Your other notes, applied

Headline → "Great ideas come at night." · "steal the files" removed · Rainforest → This website in featured projects · "Go to the community" removed · USB-C LED board and 3D-print placeholder removed from Projects · logo instead of photo on About · RSS removed from the footer (RSS = a feed for news-reader apps; it still exists, just not advertised).

"Is there an easy way to update the Now making strip?" Yes. It now reads one tiny file, `now.json`: project, stage, percent. Edit it on GitHub from your phone, or tell me "now making X, 70%".

Still need from you

- ☐ Does youtube.com/@midnightlite exist yet, or should the YouTube buttons wait?
- ☐ Instagram handle (or drop Instagram from the footer): _____
- ☐ ESP32 cam, Rainforest photos and Raspberry Pi stay on Projects below your three? ☐ Yes ☐ Hide them for now
- ☐ Newsletter: sign up for Buttondown (free) and tell me the username, and I'll wire the boxes to it.
- ☐ Happy with this draft → I start the Astro build on the preview branch.

NOTES

NAV

Midnight Lite

Home | Projects | Videos | Build log | Tools | About | Contact | ▶ YouTube

H1

3D PRINTING · ROBOTS · PHOTOGRAPHY · ELECTRIC STUFF

Great ideas come at night.

Circuits, robots, prints and photos: the whole messy process, from the first sketch to the thing that finally works. Watch the videos and read the build logs.

▶ Watch on YouTube | See the projects | Read the build log

H1 hero. Changed: your headline; "steal the files" removed; third button now goes to the build log (no on-site discussion).

H2

NOW MAKING **Ferrofluid display add-on** · coil driver board, layout stage — 60%

H2 "Now making" strip. Easy update: it reads one tiny file, `now.json` (project, stage, percent). Edit it on GitHub from your phone, or just tell me "now making X, 70%". No HTML.

H3

What you'll find here

3D printing
Functional prints, print profiles and the failures that taught me something.

Robots
Motors, sensors and firmware, built up one revision at a time.

Photography
Shots, gear notes and DIY rigs for getting the picture.

Electric stuff
KiCad boards with schematics, datasheets, BOMs and the maths behind them.

H3 topics. Approved as is.

H4

Latest video · YouTube embed goes here

LATEST VIDEO

Ep. 1: Why I'm building a ferrofluid display

The idea, the magnets, and the first board that didn't work. 12 min.

▶ Watch | Read the build log

Don't miss the next one
New videos and build logs, about twice a month. No spam.

you@example.com | Subscribe

H4 latest video + newsletter. Newsletter: **yes** (Buttondown free tier; you sign up, I wire the box to it). Video pulls automatically from youtube.com/@midnightlite.

H5

Featured projects

All projects →

BOARD RENDER

IN PROGRESS · Electric · KiCad

Ferrofluid display add-on

An electromagnet driver board that makes ferrofluid dance to music.

CAMERA PHOTO

IN PROGRESS · Electric · ESP32

ESP32 cam for fun

A DIY Wi-Fi camera that streams live video for home monitoring, because why not.

SITE SCREENSHOT

IN PROGRESS · Web & software · Astro

This website

Hand-built HTML in 2025, now rebuilt around videos and build logs. Every step is documented.

H5 featured projects. Changed: Rainforest swapped for This website.

H6

From the build log

All posts →

16 OCT 2026 · SITE UPDATES

Rebuilding this website (again)

What changed, what got cut, and why the site now centres on videos and build logs.

5 min read

[COMING SOON] · ELECTRIC

Picking a coil driver that won't cook itself

MOSFETs, flyback diodes and the maths for how warm it gets.

Draft

[COMING SOON] · ELECTRIC

First schematic and the parts list

From napkin sketch to a KiCad schematic, plus where the datasheets live.

Draft

H6 build log. Approved. First real post is the website rebuild (your request); the two ferrofluid posts follow as you write them.

H7

Building something similar?

Ask in the YouTube comments, suggest the next video, or email me about collaborations.

Email me

H7 call-out. Changed: "Go to the community" removed; questions go to YouTube comments. Footer: RSS link removed (RSS = a feed for news-reader apps; the feed still exists quietly, just not advertised).

FOOT

Midnight Lite

3D printing, robots, photography and electric stuff. Built in the open, documented as I go.

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NAV

Midnight Lite — Home | Projects | Videos | Build log | Tools | About | Contact | ▶ YouTube

P1

PORTFOLIO

Projects

Everything I've built or am building, with the files, the notes and what went wrong.
Pick a topic or just scroll.

P1 intro. Short and personal. This page doubles as your skills portfolio, so each card links to a full case study.

P2

All | 3D printing | Robots | Photography | Electric | Web & software

Search projects...

P2 filters. Topic chips + search. Statuses: *In progress* (blue), *Done* (amber), *Coming soon* (grey).

P3

BOARD RENDER

IN PROGRESS · Electric · KiCad

Ferrofluid display add-on

An electromagnet driver board that makes ferrofluid dance to music.

▶ 1 video · 3 build logs · updated 4 days ago

SITE SCREENSHOT

IN PROGRESS · Web & software

This website

Hand-built HTML in 2025, now rebuilt in Astro around videos and build logs.

1 build log · updated today

APP SCREENSHOT

LIVE · Web & software · React

EUC World data visualiser

Upload an EUC World ride log and see the map, speed and battery charts.

Try it in Tools →

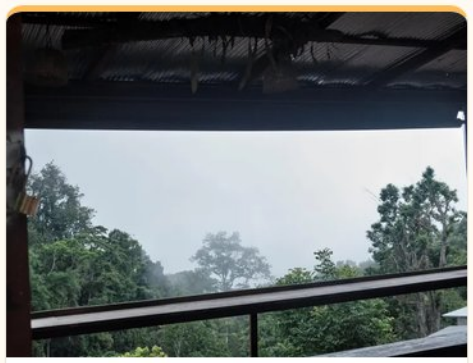
CAMERA PHOTO

IN PROGRESS · Electric · ESP32

ESP32 cam for fun

A DIY Wi-Fi surveillance camera that streams live video, because why not.

2 build logs · updated 3 weeks ago



DONE · Photography

Rainforest mornings

A photo set from the hills: fog, green and a lot of waiting.

12 photos

COMING SOON

COMING SOON · Robots · Raspberry Pi

Raspberry Pi project

Details soon. Something fun and probably slightly over-engineered.

P3 project grid. Changed: USB-C LED board and the 3D-print placeholder removed. Your three ticked projects (Ferrofluid, This website, EUC visualiser) come first.

FOOT

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D1

PROJECTS / ELECTRIC

Ferrofluid display add-on

An electromagnet driver board that makes ferrofluid dance to music. *[placeholder text: your one-paragraph summary]*

▶ Watch the video | Get the files | Ask a question

D1 project header. The case-study template every project uses. Title, one-paragraph summary, 3 quick actions.

D2

HERO PHOTO OR 3D BOARD RENDER

D2 hero image. Best photo/render. Click opens a gallery (your old lightbox.js can be reused).

D3

Why I built it

[Placeholder] The idea, the inspiration, what problem it solves or why it's fun. Two or three short paragraphs in your own words.

How it works

[Placeholder] A plain-English explanation with one diagram: audio in → analyser → coil driver → electromagnets → ferrofluid.

BLOCK DIAGRAM

The build

[Placeholder] Key decisions and the maths, pulled from the project's `DESIGN.md`: coil current, MOSFET choice, heat. Link to the full build logs below.

> **What went wrong:** [placeholder] the honest bit people love: the mistake and how it was fixed.

Result

[Placeholder] Photos/video of it working, what you'd change next time.

D3 story. Fixed structure (Why / How / Build / What went wrong / Result) makes projects quick to write up and easy to read. Content can be copied from the KiCad `DESIGN.md` files.

D4

Build logs & videos

12 Oct 2026
Picking a coil driver that won't cook itself

5 Oct 2026
▶ Ep. 1: Why I'm building a ferrofluid display

28 Sep 2026
First schematic and the parts list

D4 timeline. Every post/video tagged with this project shows up here automatically, newest first.

D5

Files

Schematic (PDF)
Exported from KiCad.

BOM (Excel)
Parts, suppliers, datasheets.

Gerbers
Ready for JLCPCB / PCBWay.

Source on GitHub
Firmware + KiCad project.

D5 files. Optional per project. KiCad exports (schematic PDF, BOM .xlsx, Gerbers) already come out of the NUC's kicad-docs tool. Public only for projects you choose to open-source.

D6

Questions & comments

Comments live on YouTube, under the video for this project. I read and answer them there.

▶ Comment on YouTube | Email me

D6 questions. Changed: no on-site comments (your choice: YouTube comments only). Links to the project's video; email for anything private.

D7

At a glance

Status	IN PROGRESS
Started	Sep 2026
Topics	Electric · KiCad
Skills	PCB design, power electronics
Tools	KiCad 10, ESP32
Cost	~$[placeholder]

On this page

Why I built it
How it works
The build
Result
Build logs & videos
Files
Questions

D7 sidebar. "At a glance" facts make it work as a portfolio piece (skills, tools). Sticks while scrolling on desktop; moves to the top on phones.

FOOT

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V1

YOUTUBE CHANNEL

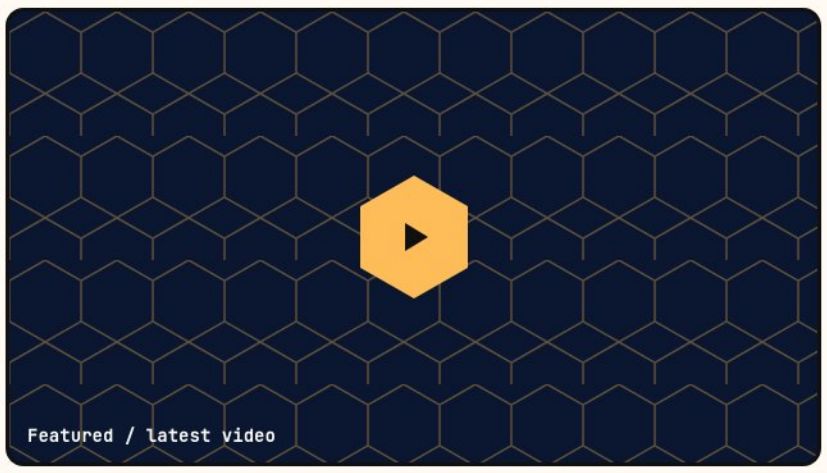
Videos

▶ Subscribe on YouTube

Build videos, quick tips and the occasional disaster. New episodes about twice a month.

V1 channel header. Links to the channel. Once the channel exists, this page fills itself from the channel's feed (no manual updates).

V2



NEW

Ep. 1: Why I'm building a ferrofluid display

The idea, the magnets, and the first board that didn't work.

Chapters: 0:00 Intro · 1:20 How ferrofluid moves · 4:05 The driver board · 9:40 First test

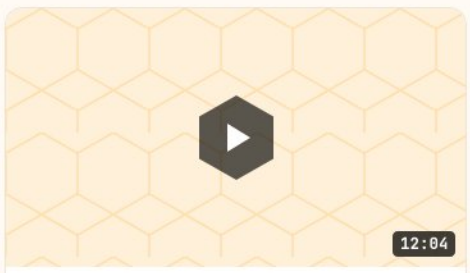
Project page | Build log

V2 featured video. The newest (or a pinned) video with chapters and links to its project page and build log. Videos and projects link both ways.

V3

Series

All | Ferrofluid display | Quick tips | Photography walks | Shorts



FERROFLUID DISPLAY · EP. 1

Why I'm building a ferrofluid display



FERROFLUID DISPLAY · EP. 2

[Planned] Driving the coils



QUICK TIPS · SHORT

[Planned] USB-C in 60 seconds: the 5.1k trick



PHOTOGRAPHY WALKS

[Planned] Rainforest in the fog with the X100



ROBOTS

[Planned] ESP32 camera, part 1



3D PRINTING

[Planned] Printing the enclosure

V3 series grid. Videos grouped by series (= YouTube playlists). [Planned] ones show what's coming. Is a "Shorts" row worth having?

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B1

BLOG

Build log

Written notes from the bench: progress, the maths, the mistakes. Shorter than a video, more detail than a caption.

B1 intro. Named "Build log" rather than "Blog" to fit the maker theme (and it absorbs the old Dev Log page). Rename if you prefer.

B2

All | Electric | Robots | 3D printing | Photography | Web | Site updates

B2 filters. Same topics as projects, plus "Site updates" (the old changelog).

B3

BEFORE / AFTER

16 OCT 2026 · SITE UPDATES · THIS WEBSITE

Rebuilding this website (again)

What changed, what got cut, and why the site now centres on videos and build logs.

5 min read

[COMING SOON] · ELECTRIC · FERROFLUID DISPLAY

Picking a coil driver that won't cook itself

MOSFETs, flyback diodes and the maths for how warm it gets.

Draft · ▶ goes with Ep. 1

[COMING SOON] · ELECTRIC · FERROFLUID DISPLAY

First schematic and the parts list

From napkin sketch to a KiCad schematic, plus where the datasheets live.

Draft

B3 post list. Changed: the website rebuild is the first real post; ferrofluid posts are drafts until you write them. No comment counts (comments are on YouTube).

B4

Search

Search posts...

Series

Ferrofluid display (soon)
This website (1)

Get new posts

New posts and videos by email, about twice a month.

you@example.com

Subscribe

B4 sidebar. Changed: RSS button removed; newsletter box instead.

FOOT

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A1

BUILD LOG · SITE UPDATES · THIS WEBSITE

Rebuilding this website (again)

16 Oct 2026 · 5 min read · by @midnightlite

A1 post header. This is now your **first real post**, documenting the redesign (your note on the decisions page). Wording is a draft in your voice; mark up anything that doesn't sound like you.

A2

The first version of this site was hand-written HTML and CSS: a few coding projects mashed together, a carousel on the home page, and a "Services" page that was really just a launcher for my own web apps. Later a GitHub bot helped me clean it up a lot. It worked, but it was built for showing a CV, not for what I actually want to do now: make videos, write up builds, and share the whole process.

So I'm rebuilding it around three things: **projects**, **videos** and **build logs**. Here's what changed and why.

What moved where

Old site	New site	Why
Home (hero + carousel)	Home	One clear pitch, a "now making" strip, the latest video, featured projects and recent posts.
Projects + project1–3 pages	Projects + one case-study layout	Every project gets the same structure: why, how, the build, what went wrong, result, files.
(none)	Videos	Hub for the new YouTube channel, grouped by series.
Dev Log	Build log	A real blog. This post is the first one.
Services	Tools	"Services" sounded like I was selling something. They're free tools; the EUC World visualiser lives here.
Contact (footer only)	Contact page	A proper form, plus video suggestions. The placeholder phone number and LinkedIn are gone.

Decisions I made

- **Built with Astro.** Posts and projects are now Markdown files instead of hand-written HTML pages, so writing a new post takes minutes. It still produces plain, fast pages on Netlify.
- **Comments live on YouTube.** No comment system on the site to moderate or keep running. Ask under the video and I'll answer there.
- **A newsletter.** New videos and build logs about twice a month, by email. No spam.
- **Faceless for now.** I'm @midnightlite, and the hexagon logo does the talking.
- **Fewer, better projects.** I start with three: the ferrofluid display, the EUC visualiser and this website. More get added as they become worth showing.

BEFORE / AFTER SCREENSHOT OF THE HOME PAGE

How I'm building it

The layout started as a clickable prototype that I printed, scribbled on and sent back (the headline you see on the home page came from that round). The source lives on GitHub and is backed up to my own Git server at home, and every change goes to a preview branch before it reaches the live site.

> Lesson so far: printing a design and attacking it with a pen finds problems much faster than staring at it on a screen.

What's next

Moving the real content across, then the first ferrofluid build logs to go with Ep. 1 on YouTube.

A2 article. Written in Markdown in the Astro version. Drop in a real before/after screenshot. Every claim here matches your markup decisions; change the tone freely.

A3

← First post

Next: Picking a coil driver [coming soon] →

A3 series navigation. Previous / next post.

A4

Questions & comments

Comments live on YouTube. Ask under the latest video, or email me.

▶ Comment on YouTube | Email me

A4 questions. Changed: on-site discussion replaced by a YouTube link (your choice).

FOOT

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Home Projects Videos Build log Tools About Contact ▶ YouTube

AB1

ABOUT

Hi, I'm Midnight Lite.

Online I'm **@midnightlite**. I make circuits, robots, prints and photos, mostly late at night. Midnight Lite is where I share the whole process so others can learn from it (and from my mistakes).

See my work | ▶ YouTube | Get in touch

AB1 intro. Changed: handle @midnightlite with the logo instead of a photo (faceless for now).

AB2

Skills

Electronics
PCB design (KiCad), power & USB-C, ESP32, Raspberry Pi, soldering.

Software
Python, JavaScript/React, embedded C, home-server tinkering.

Making
3D printing, CAD, enclosures, robotics.

Photography
Fujifilm X100, landscapes and travel, editing.

AB2 skills. This is what makes it a portfolio. Edit to your real skill list; each could link to the projects that prove it.

AB3

Timeline

2026
Launching the YouTube channel and build log.

2026
First custom PCBs: USB-C power, ferrofluid driver.

2025
Built this website from scratch; EUC World visualiser.

[year]
[Placeholder: study / work milestone]

Gear I use

Camera	Fujifilm X100 [model]
Printer	[placeholder]
PCB design	KiCad 10
Microcontrollers	ESP32, Raspberry Pi
Home lab	Self-hosted server, NAS

AB3 timeline + gear. Viewers always ask "what camera/printer is that?". Gear can later use affiliate links if you want.

FOOT

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T1

FREE WEB TOOLS

Tools

Small apps I built for my own projects, free to use in your browser. Nothing you upload leaves your computer.

T1 intro. Replaces the old "Services" page (the name suggested paid services). Your existing EUC visualiser moves here unchanged.

T2

APP SCREENSHOT

LIVE · EUC · Maps & charts

EUC World data visualiser

Upload an EUC World ride log (CSV) to see your route on a map plus speed, battery and temperature charts.

IDEA

IDEA · Electric

[Idea] LED resistor calculator

Supply voltage + LED colour → resistor value and power, with the maths shown.

IDEA

IDEA · 3D printing

[Idea] Print cost estimator

Filament weight + price + power → what a print really costs.

T2 tools. Real tool + two ideas that would suit the channel (tools bring search traffic). Keep, drop or add your own ideas.

FOOT

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Home Projects Videos Build log Tools About Contact ▶ YouTube

C1

CONTACT

Say hello

Questions about a build, an idea for the next video, or a collaboration. Here's where to find me.

C1 intro. Changed: "Community" became "Contact", because discussion now happens in the YouTube comments (your choice).

C2

Ask about a build

Comment under the video. I read and answer them, and other viewers often help too.

▶ YouTube

Suggest a video

What should I build or explain next? Use the form below and pick "Video idea".

Suggest an idea

Get new posts

New videos and build logs by email, about twice a month.

you@example.com Subscribe

C2 ways to reach you. Changed: Discussions board and Discord chat removed; YouTube, video ideas and the newsletter instead.

C3

Send a message

For collaborations, sponsorships, video ideas or anything private.

Your name

Email

General

Message

Send

Or email enquiry@midnight-lite.com

C3 contact form. Netlify Forms (free on your current host, no server). Messages arrive by email to enquiry@midnight-lite.com.

FOOT

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Menu

▶ YouTube

3D PRINTING · ROBOTS · PHOTOGRAPHY · ELECTRIC STUFF

Great ideas come at night.

Circuits, robots, prints and photos: the whole messy process, from the first sketch to the thing that finally works. Watch the videos and read the build logs.

▶ Watch on YouTube

See the projects

Read the build log

NOW MAKING

Ferrofluid display add-on · coil driver board, layout stage

60%

What you'll find here

3D printing

Functional prints, print profiles and the failures that taught me something.

Robots

Motors, sensors and firmware, built up one revision at a time.

Photography

Shots, gear notes and DIY rigs for getting the picture.

Electric stuff

KiCad boards with schematics, datasheets, BOMs and the maths behind them.

Latest video · YouTube embed goes here

LATEST VIDEO

Ep. 1: Why I'm building a ferrofluid display

The idea, the magnets, and the first board that didn't work. 12 min.

▶ Watch

Read the build log

Don't miss the next one

New videos and build logs, about twice a month. No spam.

you@example.com

Subscribe

Featured projects

All projects →

BOARD RENDER

IN PROGRESS · Electric · KiCad

Ferrofluid display add-on

An electromagnet driver board that makes ferrofluid dance to music.

CAMERA PHOTO

IN PROGRESS · Electric · ESP32

ESP32 cam for fun

A DIY Wi-Fi camera that streams live video for home monitoring, because why not.

SITE SCREENSHOT

IN PROGRESS · Web & software · Astro

This website

Hand-built HTML in 2025, now rebuilt around videos and build logs. Every step is documented.

From the build log

All posts →

16 OCT 2026 · SITE UPDATES

Rebuilding this website (again)

What changed, what got cut, and why the site now centres on videos and build logs.

5 min read

[COMING SOON] · ELECTRIC

Picking a coil driver that won't cook itself

MOSFETs, flyback diodes and the maths for how warm it gets.

Draft

[COMING SOON] · ELECTRIC

First schematic and the parts list

From napkin sketch to a KiCad schematic, plus where the datasheets live.

Draft

Building something similar?

Ask in the YouTube comments, suggest the next video, or email me about collaborations.

Email me

Midnight Lite

3D printing, robots, photography and electric stuff. Built in the open, documented as I go.

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About

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